

The Wary Flinch

Player-facing description

The Wary Flinch: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it.

GM truth

Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.

GM handling

Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Wary Flinch when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-wary-flinch-engage-the-wary-flinch entity-the-wary-flinch Engage The Wary Flinch Engage The Wary Flinch Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Wary Flinch hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move

that...

- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Player-safe note: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it.

Profile

- Schema Version: clue-profile-v1
- Id: the-wary-flinch
- Clue Id: the-wary-flinch
- Clue Name: The Wary Flinch
- Name: The Wary Flinch
- Pronunciation: the WAIR-ee FLINCH
- Clue Kind: behavioral
- Auto Surface: True
- Atlas Lore Note: [Atlas lore - confirm or override]
- Player Safe: The Wary Flinch The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it. The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it. The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it.
- Block0: the-wary-flinch The Wary Flinch the WAIR-ee FLINCH behavioral
- Block1: it's behaving like prey, not a predator defending a kill. OBVIOUS The Creature Is Innocent the-creature-is-innocent Lets the table choose mercy and see nature contradict the opening propaganda. <pages/entities/the-wary-flinch.html> <pages/clues/the-creature-is-innocent.html>
- Block2: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it. it's behaving like prey, not a predator defending a kill.
- Block3: "it keeps flinching back." "it's scared of you, not stalking you." "this animal is terrified, not hostile." "it's harmless unless you corner it."
- Block4: Feeding Not Hunting The Late Tracks the-late-tracks
- Block5: S01-02 S01-03 Overturned Vendor Cart Strixwolf Mother Instinct 12; an animal-handler PC reads it free. clues/The_Creature_Is_Innocent.md
- Block6: MANDATORY Use this clue to support The Creature Is Innocent: it's behaving like prey, not a predator defending a kill. whisper
- Block8: Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon. Depict: a wolf-owl creature crouched low, ears flat, wings tucked, wary eyes. clue wiki card and Player Display evidence visual Send the image and SHOW text only. Keep TELL, points_to, and blunt ladder rungs GM-only until earned.

/Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-wary-flinch/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-wary-flinch/profile_base.png Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no...

- Block9: Official Daggerheart action roll using Duality Dice, Hope, Fear, and Difficulty; P2P Roll Slider is the table-facing result ladder. Agility move, climb, dodge, reach a better angle, or read evidence while moving Strength lift, hold, force, carry, break, or test weight and pressure Finesse handle, hide, tinker, compare, pick apart, or notice precise detail Instinct perceive, smell, listen, track, read danger, or sense body language Presence charm, soothe, press, lead, deceive, perform, or read a social response Knowledge recall, analyze, investigate, reason from lore, or understand systems Agility D11 Instinct D11 Presence D11 If the clue is plainly visible, give the SHOW text freely first: The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it. Use the listed Difficulty for the...
- Mechanics: duality-dice hope fear difficulty roll-slider clue-discovery
- Visual Assets: profile_base Clue evidence image /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-wary-flinch/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-wary-flinch/profile_base.png ready The Wary Flinch clue image. The creature watches your every movement and shrinks from it ? ears flat, wings tucked, ready to bolt, not to pounce. It is more afraid of you than you are of it.

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